HARDIK CHHABRA



“We need to have theatres of different kinds. There are vast districts which don’t have a single screen”

— AAMIR KHAN *at the World Audio Visual & Entertainment Summit, May 2025*

“It’s been feast and famine after Covid-19. Suddenly a big movie comes along and hits the jackpot, then it’s a famine”

— AJAY BIJLI, *Founder, PVR Cinemas, and MD, PVR INOX Ltd, at WAVES*



media and entertainment sector states the need for low-priced theatres in Tier III and IV markets alongside growth in “mass-themed films”. Five months into 2025, there has been only one that fits the bill—*Chhaava*, a period action drama on Maratha ruler Chhatrapati Sambhaji Maharaj, which collected Rs 530 crore, a significant chunk of it coming from Maharashtra. Bollywood’s sluggish start to the year